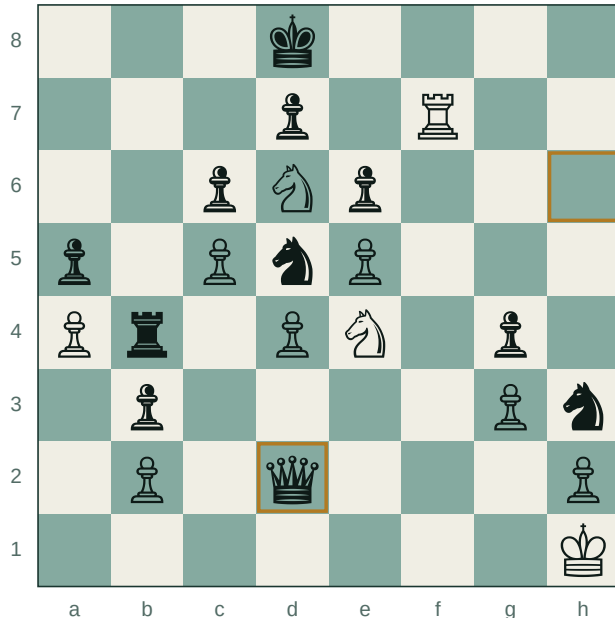


Hook mating nets: White, move 38

Hook mating nets

White to move



Previous move: 37...Qxd2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

38. Rf8+ Kc7 39. Rc8#

38.Rf8+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **38...Kc7**.

39.Rc8# Mate: rook on c8 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on c7. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on c8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Recount the king's legal replies after each move. A changed pawn placement can destroy an otherwise familiar mating pattern.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A hook-type mating net combines rook pressure with knight control and supporting pawn geometry. The supporting pieces can matter more than the apparent value of a sacrifice.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the final checking line and then trace which friendly pieces protect the attacker and control the king's exits.

The defending king is on d8. Geometrically undefended: queen on d2. Check for tactical protection.